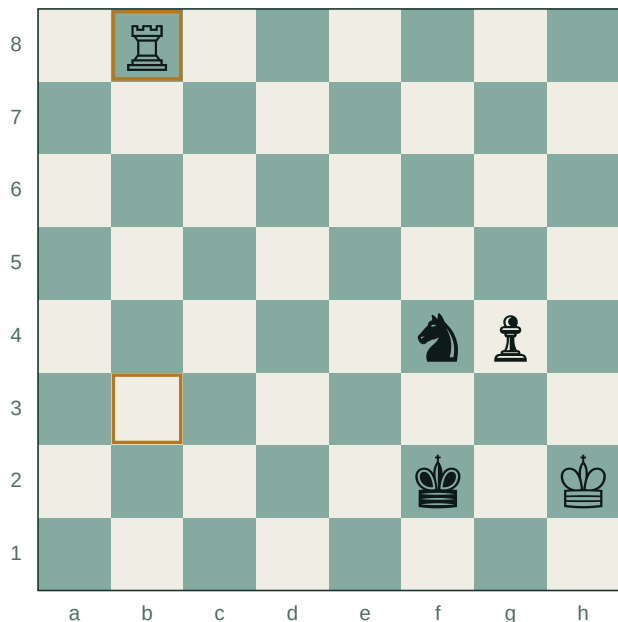


Exposed-king tactics: Black, move 66

Exposed-king tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 66.Rb8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

66...g3+ 67. Kh1 g2+ 68. Kh2 g1=Q#

66...g3+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **67.Kh1**.

67...g2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **68.Kh2**.

68...g1=Q# Mate: queen on g1 gives check; White has no legal reply. The pawn becomes a queen.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h2. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on g1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A king without pawns is not automatically mated. Count active attackers and examine escapes toward friendly pieces.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An exposed king gives the attacker checks and access to nearby squares. Coordinate pieces so the checks drive it into a worse net rather than toward safety.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect open files, diagonals, and unprotected squares around the king. Calculate checks in an order that preserves the attack.

The defending king is on h2. Geometrically undefended: rook on b8. Check for tactical protection.